

Subject Description Form

Subject Code	APSS321																				
Subject Title	Abnormal Psychology																				
Credit Value	3																				
Level	3																				
Pre-requisite / Co-requisite/ Exclusion	<u>Pre-requisite:</u> APSS111/APSS1A07/APSS222 Introduction to Psychology																				
Assessment Methods	<table><tr><td>100% Continuous Assessment</td><td>Individual Assessment</td><td>Group Assessment</td></tr><tr><td>1. Quiz</td><td>40 %</td><td>--</td></tr><tr><td>2. Group Presentation</td><td>--</td><td>30%</td></tr><tr><td>3. Individual Paper</td><td>20 %</td><td>--</td></tr><tr><td>4. Class Participation</td><td>10 %</td><td>--</td></tr><tr><td>0% Examination</td><td>--</td><td>--</td></tr></table>			100% Continuous Assessment	Individual Assessment	Group Assessment	1. Quiz	40 %	--	2. Group Presentation	--	30%	3. Individual Paper	20 %	--	4. Class Participation	10 %	--	0% Examination	--	--
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Objectives	The subject aims to provide students with an overview of major psychological approaches to the explanation of abnormal human behaviors. It is also aimed at equipping students with knowledge and related intervention strategies to help people with “abnormal” labels. As a result, the students can become sensitive to special needs of individuals, and appreciate the importance of applying the acquired psychological concepts in their daily lives, indigenous cultural context, and/ or professional practice.																				
Intended Learning Outcomes (Note 1)	Upon completion of the subject, the students will be able to: a. acquire an overview of major psychological approaches and concepts to the explanation of abnormal human behaviors; and b. recognize the complex difficulties and interventions associated with behaviors labeled as “abnormal”; and c. sensitize to the special needs of individuals with psychopathological problems; and d. apply the acquired psychological concepts and skills in daily lives, indigenous culture, and/ or relevant professional practice.																				

Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus <i>(Note 2)</i>	Part One: Theoretical Considerations 1. Concepts of Normality and Abnormality - Definition, misconceptions, and concepts of mental health 2. Perspectives of Abnormal Behavior a. Medical Perspective b. Psychodynamic, Behavioral - Cognitive, and Existential Perspectives c. Family and Interactive Perspectives d. Multiple Causation of Abnormal Behavior Part Two: Problems of Human Behaviors 1) Understanding the following disorders in terms of their nature, classifications, characteristics, causation and treatment: - Anxiety Disorders - Obsessive Compulsive Disorders - Trauma-related Disorders - Depression Disorders - Bipolar and Related Disorders - Schizophrenia Spectrum and Psychotic Disorders - Neurodevelopmental Disorders (ADHD & ASD) - Personality Disorders - Neurocognitive Disorders 2) Perspectives on Community Mental Health - Concepts of Primary, Secondary and Tertiary Prevention - Overview of psychological interventions
Teaching/Learning Methodology <i>(Note 3)</i>	Lectures will be the main component to help students learn and develop a comprehensive understanding of recent approaches in abnormal psychology. In-depth case studies with the aid of audio-visual materials will also be used for teaching materials. The lecturer will analyze and reconstruct the conceptualization of assessment and management of various types of problems. In addition, in order to facilitate students to gain practical experiences in application, they will be required to conduct a small scale project on the chosen topic by literature search and case presentations, lastly writing an individual seminar paper for assessment.

Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes <i>(Note 4)</i>	<table><tr><th rowspan="2">Specific assessment methods/tasks</th><th rowspan="2">% weighting</th><th colspan="4">Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)</th></tr><tr><th>a</th><th>b</th><th>c</th><th>d</th></tr><tr><td>1. Quiz</td><td>40 %</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td></tr><tr><td>2. Group Presentation</td><td>30 %</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td></tr><tr><td>3. Individual Paper</td><td>20 %</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td></tr><tr><td>4. Class Participation</td><td>10%</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td></tr><tr><td>Total</td><td>100 %</td><td colspan="4"></td></tr></table> Explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes: The quiz is to help students to develop a firm grasp of basic concepts while the project and individual paper are to help them develop independent and analytical thinking. • The grade is calculated according to the percentage assigned; • Peer evaluation is included to ensure and evaluate each student’s contribution to the group project. • The completion and submission of all component assignments are required for passing the subject; and • Student must pass all of the component assignments at the grade of D (standard of passing) if he/she is to pass the subject.					Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)				a	b	c	d	1. Quiz	40 %	✓	✓	✓	✓	2. Group Presentation	30 %	✓	✓	✓	✓	3. Individual Paper	20 %	✓	✓	✓	✓	4. Class Participation	10%	✓	✓	✓	✓	Total	100 %				
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Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:																																												
	▪ Lecture		36	Hrs.																																									
	Other student study effort:																																												
	▪ Self-Study		42	Hrs.																																									
	▪ Written Paper		30	Hrs.																																									
	▪ Group Preparation		30	Hrs.																																									
	Total student study effort		138	Hrs.																																									

Reading List and References	<u>MAIN REFERENCE:</u> Bridley, A. & Daffin, Lee W. Jr. (2024). <i>Fundamentals of Psychological Disorders (3rd ed.)</i>. Pressbooks. https://opentext.wsu.edu/abnormal-psych/ <u>OTHER REFERENCES:</u> <i>ABNORMAL PSYCHOLOGY</i> Jill M. Hooley James Neall Seventeenth edition Butcher; Matthew Nock; Susan Mineka; Boston : Pearson 2017 . (Reserve Collection) <u>First Reference Available Online from POLYU LIB</u> BOOK <i>Abnormal psychology</i> Credo Reference (Firm), Boston, Massachusetts : Credo Reference 2014 [Enhanced Credo edition]. BOOK <i>DSM-5TM essentials : the savvy clinician's guide to the changes in criteria</i> Lourie W. Reichenberg 1956- David Riedy; Hoboken, New Jersey : Wiley 2014 Recommended Readings <i>A brief summary of changes in DSM-5-TR</i> 1. First, M. B., Clarke, D. E., Yousif, L., Eng, A. M., Gogtay, N., & Appelbaum, P. S. (2022). DSM-5-TR: Rationale, process, and overview of changes. <i>Psychiatric Services</i>, appi-ps. <i>A brief overview of the mental health issues in China</i> 1. Xu, Z. et al. (2022). The state of mental health care in China. <i>Asian Journal of Psychiatry</i>, 69, 102975.
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Note 1: Intended Learning Outcomes

Intended learning outcomes should state what students should be able to do or attain upon completion of the subject. Subject outcomes are expected to contribute to the attainment of the overall programme outcomes.

Note 2: Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus

The syllabus should adequately address the intended learning outcomes. At the same time over-crowding of the syllabus should be avoided.

Note 3: Teaching/Learning Methodology

This section should include a brief description of the teaching and learning methods to be employed to facilitate learning, and a justification of how the methods are aligned with the intended learning outcomes of the subject.

Note 4: Assessment Method

This section should include the assessment method(s) to be used and its relative weighting, and indicate which of the subject intended learning outcomes that each method purports to assess. It should also provide a brief explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes.